

ECOLOGICAL SUBSISTENCE

BUSINESS MODEL FOR A HOLISTIC GROWTH



THE PROBLEMS

- Unilever is still heavily dependent on disposable packaging, linear supply chains, and extractive sourcing practices, which contribute to waste, adversely affecting the planetary boundaries.
- Despite ongoing efforts in RECYCLING and REGENERATIVE AGRICULTURE, the company lacks a fully integrated circular system, such as large-scale reuse, reverse logistics, and ecosystem restoration models.
- This is critical to addressing environmental impact, meeting regulatory expectations, and satisfying eco-conscious consumers

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SLOWING STRATEGY

2

TURN DISPOSABLES INTO A REUSABLE SERVICE ECOSYSTEM

(Make use of or provide services that replace disposable with durable products.)

- Effective Material- Technical Loop (Circular Business Model)
- Following the DFR & PLE
- Helps to regulate the “Freshwater Change” - Planetary Boundary.

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SOLID & WATER LESS PRODUCT FORMATS :

- Instead of selling liquid soaps, shampoos, and detergents in plastic bottles.
- Unilever could convert them into solid, concentrated, or powder formats, reducing the need for packaging altogether.

How It Works:

- Shampoos & conditioners in bar or powder.
- Cleaning products are offered in concentrated dissolvable sheets or tablets.
- Customers mix with water at home, using refillable glass dispensers.

Why It's Unique:

- Removes single-use plastic entirely. Lightweight & compact—reduces logistics costs & carbon footprint.

BULK REFILL STATIONS IN STORES :

- Consumers bring their own containers to Unilever-branded bulk dispensing stations in supermarkets.
- Allows consumers to refill personal care and home care products (like detergents, lotions, and oils) as per their desire.

How It Works

- Unilever partners with retailers (e.g., Carrefour, Tesco, etc) to install smart refill stations.
- Customers get to customise the quantity of the product.

Why It's Unique:

- Eliminates unnecessary plastic packaging. Saves consumers money, paying only for what they need.
- Removes single-use plastic entirely. Lightweight & compact—reduces logistics costs & carbon footprint.

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CLOSING STRATEGY

2

DESIGN WITH RECYCLED INPUTS:

(Design with materials that have been recycled from other products and components.)

- Effective Material- Technical Loop (Circular Business Model)
- Following the DFR.
- Helps to regulate several - Planetary Boundaries.

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"UPCYCLED* PLASTIC & ORGANIC WASTE PACKAGING":

- Instead of focusing on recycled plastics, Unilever could combine upcycled plastic waste with agricultural or food waste to create hybrid, sustainable packaging materials.
- This would move beyond traditional recycling by integrating waste streams from multiple industries into packaging innovation.

*UPCYLING:

"Upcycling, also known as creative reuse, is the process of transforming by-products, waste materials, useless, or unwanted products into new materials or products perceived to be of greater quality, such as artistic value or environmental value." - WIKIPEDIA

How It Works:

- Plastic Waste + Organic Waste Blends - Develop packaging that combines post-consumer recycled plastic with waste by-products from its own supply chain.
- Tea Leaves Waste (from Lipton) - Mixed with bio-resins for compostable packaging.
- Cocoa Husks (from Magnum ice cream) - Reinforced with recycled plastic for stronger, textured bottles.

Why It's Unique:

- Goes beyond just recycling plastic - Leverages multiple waste streams in one innovative packaging solution.
- Utilizes Unilever's own waste footprint - Creates a closed-loop system for its tea, cocoa, and agricultural by-products.
- Aligns with Unilever's Net Zero Goals - Reduces carbon emissions by upcycling natural waste and minimizing virgin plastic.

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∞ REGENERATING STRATEGY

2

MANAGE AND SUSTAIN CRITICAL ECOSYSTEM SERVICES:

(Engage in projects that manage and sustain the natural ecosystems that surround and affect your business operations.)

- Symbiotic Ecosystem (Circular Business Model)
- Following the IS.
- Helps to regulate the "Biosphere Integrity"- Planetary Boundaries.

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RESTORING ENDANGERED ECOSYSTEMS WITHIN SUPPLY CHAIN :

- Unilever could go beyond regenerative agriculture by actively restoring endangered ecosystems connected to its supply chain, such as rainforests, mangroves, and wetlands.
- This could create corridors of restored biodiversity in key sourcing regions, ensuring long-term environmental sustainability while securing essential raw materials.

A company of Unilever's stature can profit a lot from creating its own "Supply Chain" rather than relying on the Rain Forest Alliance (RFA) by gaining control over the sustainability and also reducing its long-term expenditure. This process enhances brand differentiation and strengthens Unilever's competitive edge.

How It Works:

- Identify High-Risk Ecosystems - Focus on regions where Unilever sources key ingredients.
- Biodiversity Corridors - Work with local communities & NGOs to replant native species

Why It's Unique:

- Goes beyond sustainability - Actively restores entire ecosystems.
- No FMCG competitor has implemented a biodiversity corridor program at scale.

THANK YOU

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